



TB AUDIO PLUG-INS
Team Impulse Impact

USER MANUAL

TB Shimmer

Granular Shimmer and Diffuse Tail

Pitch-shifted, reversible grains climb through filtered feedback and bloom into an eight-line diffuse tail, from distinct sparks to a wide, floating cloud.

13 panel controls

Pitch -12 to +24 st

Tail decay up to 45 s

100 factory presets



Contents

- 01 Overview
- 02 Quick start
- 03 Interface
- 04 Controls
- 05 Presets
- 06 Recipes
- 07 Tips and troubleshooting
- 08 Parameter reference
- 09 Version history
- 10 Support and license

01 Overview

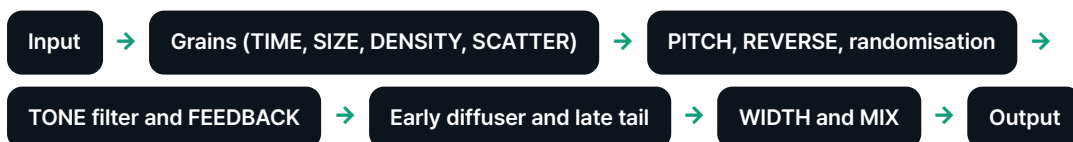
TB Shimmer cuts the incoming sound into short grains, transposes them, and feeds them back so that each new generation climbs again. The grains then pass through an early diffuser into an eight-line late tail, so the result can move from separate sparks to a smooth, rising cloud.

The upper row shapes the grains: **TIME**, **SIZE**, and **DENSITY** set where, how long, and how often grains play, **SCATTER** spreads them, and **LEVEL VAR**, **POSITION RAND**, and **PITCH SPRAY** vary each grain. The lower row sets the shimmer: **PITCH**, **REVERSE**, **FEEDBACK**, **TONE**, **WIDTH**, and **MIX**. TB Shimmer works on mono or stereo tracks, reports no latency, and needs no external feedback routing.

Key features

- Windowed grains read from the recent input, 60 to 1200 ms behind it
- PITCH from -12 to +24 semitones, with a REVERSE chance per grain
- Pitch-shifted feedback through a TONE filter, so grain generations keep rising
- Early all-pass diffuser and an eight-line late tail with a decay of up to 45 seconds
- Per-grain level, position, and pitch randomisation
- Live GRAIN HALO display driven by the parameters
- 100 factory presets in 14 groups, user presets, undo, and redo
- VST3 and standalone on Windows

Signal flow



About this manual

This manual describes TB Shimmer 1.0.0 for Windows (VST3 and standalone). The current macOS build (AU and VST3) is also version 1.0.0; small differences between platforms are possible.

02 Quick start

- 1 Insert TB Shimmer on a pad, guitar, vocal, or keys track, or on an effects return. The defaults are **PITCH** +12 st, **FEEDBACK** 42%, and **MIX** 48%.

- 2 Choose a preset from the preset list 1, or start from Init.
- 3 Set the grain pattern with **TIME**, **SIZE**, and **DENSITY** 3. Low DENSITY gives separate grain echoes; high DENSITY gives a smooth wash.
- 4 Choose the interval with **PITCH** 6, then raise **FEEDBACK** 8 to let the shimmer climb and the tail grow.
- 5 Shape the tail with **TONE** and **WIDTH**, and set the balance with **MIX** 9. On an effects return, set MIX to 100%.

03 Interface



TB Shimmer 1.0 interface with the default settings.

- 1 **Preset bar** — previous and next preset, the preset list with factory groups and user presets, Save, Undo, and Redo.
- 2 **GRAIN HALO** — a live grain field driven by the parameters, with the current pitch, density, and time.
- 3 **TIME, SIZE, DENSITY** — where grains start, how long they last, and how often they play.
- 4 **SCATTER** — grain spread and motion in the tail.
- 5 **LEVEL VAR, POSITION RAND, PITCH SPRAY** — per-grain randomisation.
- 6 **PITCH** — grain transposition in semitones.
- 7 **REVERSE** — the chance that a grain plays backward.
- 8 **FEEDBACK, TONE** — regeneration and tail brightness.
- 9 **WIDTH, MIX** — stereo spread and the dry/wet balance.

04 Controls

Grain, motion & random

Control	Range · default	What it does
TIME	60 to 1200 ms · 240 ms	Sets how far behind the input each grain begins. Short times stay close to the source; long times give separate, delayed grain echoes.
SIZE	40 to 500 ms · 160 ms	Sets the grain duration and the scale of the diffuse space. Short grains sound grainy and articulate; long grains blend smoothly.
DENSITY	2 to 24 gr/s · 9.0 gr/s	Grains per second. Moves from sparse grain echoes to a smooth, dense wash. DENSITY also sets how much diffusion and late tail are mixed in.
SCATTER	0 to 100% · 32%	Varies grain size, spreads grains across the stereo field, and adds slow motion inside the diffuse tail.
LEVEL VAR	0 to 12 dB · 0 dB	Lowers each grain's level by a random amount, up to the selected value.
POSITION RAND	0 to 100% · 32%	Randomises each grain's read-start position around TIME.
PITCH SPRAY	0 to 12 st · 0.112 st (shown as 0.1 st)	Spreads each grain's pitch continuously around the main PITCH setting.

Shimmer & output

Control	Range · default	What it does
PITCH	-12 to +24 st in semitone steps · +12 st	Transposes the grain cloud. With FEEDBACK, each new generation is transposed again, so the shimmer keeps rising (or falling with negative values). At 0 st there is no pitch shift.
REVERSE	0 to 100% · 18%	Sets the chance that a grain reads backward.
FEEDBACK	0 to 88% · 42%	Extends both the rising grain generations and the diffuse decay. The tail can last up to 45 seconds.
TONE	1.2 to 18 kHz · 9 kHz	Damps each tail circulation and sets the brightness of the wet signal. Lower values give a darker, softer tail.
WIDTH	0 to 200% · 135%	Sets the stereo spread of the combined grain and tail field. At 0% the wet field is mono, as in the Mono Bloom preset.
MIX	0 to 100% · 48%	Blends the dry input with the granular shimmer and diffuse tail.

TB Shimmer also has a host Bypass parameter. There is no bypass button on the panel.

PITCH +12 st gives the classic octave shimmer, +7 st a fifth, and +19 st an octave plus a fifth. Negative values make the tail fall instead of rise.

High FEEDBACK with long TIME and SIZE can build a long, loud tail. Raise FEEDBACK gradually and watch the output level.

05 Presets

Step through presets with the arrows, or open the list to browse the factory groups and your user presets. Save asks for a name and stores the current settings as a .tbshimmer file in Documents/TB_Shimmer/Presets/User; if the name exists, you are asked before it is replaced. Undo and Redo step through recent parameter changes. The factory presets also appear in the host's program list.

Group	Presets
START	Init, Soft Halo, Open Air
SHIMMER	Glass Halo, Guitar Ascension, Vocal Starlight
CLOUD	Pad Aurora, Slow Nebula, Wide Harmonic Fog
REVERSE	Reverse Comet, Falling Glass, Dark Orbit
UTILITY	Subtle Lift, Mono Bloom, Centered Glow, Bright Ambience, Warm Ambience, Transient Guard, Wet Shimmer Bus, Wet Diffuse Bus
DIFFUSE	Opal Chamber, Silken Room, Wide Diffusion, Warm Current, Dense Air, Slow Chamber, Short Bloom, Deep Diffusion
SPARKLE	Silver Dust, Prism Ticks, High Constellation, Fifth Glint, Octave Sparks, Bright Rain, Fine Chimes, Star Shower
RANDOM	Gentle Variation, Loose Grains, Wandering Pitch, Soft Roulette, Broken Halo, Random Current, Wide Uncertainty, Total Scatter
PULSE	Tight Glimmer, Broad Cloud, Staggered Drift, Slow Bloom, Quick Spark, Reverse Cadence, Slow Pulse, Long Cycle
VOCAL	Vocal Sheen, Vocal Octave, Vocal Air Trail, Vocal Velvet, Vocal Reverse Bloom, Vocal Choir Cloud, Vocal Shadow, Vocal Stars
GUITAR	Guitar Glow, Guitar Fifth, Guitar Octave Trail, Guitar Reverse Swell, Guitar Warm Cloud, Guitar High Mist, Guitar Low Orbit, Guitar Grain Storm
KEYS	Piano Air, Piano Halo, Electric Silk, Organ Ascension, Synth Prism, Bell Mist, Keys Reverse Air, Low Key Cloud
PADS	Pad Soft Field, Pad Octave Wash, Pad Fifth Veil, Pad Reverse Tide, Pad High Horizon, Pad Low Horizon, Pad Random Choir, Pad Endless Light
DARK	Smoked Glass, Low Tide, Dim Chamber, Shadow Reverse, Black Velvet, Dusk Spray, Deep Random, Night Bloom
EXPERIMENTAL	Frozen Fragments, Micro Swarm, Descending Mirage, Split Direction, No Pitch Cloud, Reverse Only Field, Shifting Constellation, Outer Limit

The UTILITY presets Wet Shimmer Bus and Wet Diffuse Bus use MIX 100% for effects returns. The PULSE presets use TIME values that match note lengths at 120 BPM, such as 500 ms for a quarter note; TIME does not follow the host tempo.

06 Recipes

Starting points for common jobs. Adjust them by ear.

Octave shimmer

A rising octave halo on pads or guitar.

Preset Glass Halo

PITCH +12 st

FEEDBACK 40 to 55%

1 Lower TONE if the top end gets brittle.

Vocal sheen

A subtle lift behind a lead vocal.

Preset Vocal Sheen

MIX 15 to 25%

REVERSE 0%

1 Keep SCATTER low so the words stay clear.

Reverse swell

Backward swells that rise out of a guitar part.

Preset Guitar Reverse Swell

REVERSE 70 to 100%

1 Longer SIZE makes the swells smoother.

Shimmer return

One shimmer send shared by several tracks.

Preset Wet Shimmer Bus

MIX 100%

1 Insert TB Shimmer on an effects return and set the send level on each track.

07 Tips and troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The tail grows too long or too loud.	Lower FEEDBACK, shorten TIME or SIZE, or lower MIX.
The shimmer is harsh or brittle.	Lower TONE, reduce PITCH SPRAY, or try +7 st instead of +12 st.
The grains sound choppy.	Raise DENSITY or SIZE.
The effect sounds static.	Raise SCATTER, POSITION RAND, or PITCH SPRAY slightly.
The sound is too wide or weak in mono.	Lower WIDTH.
The repeats do not follow the song tempo.	TIME is free-running. Set it by ear, or calculate it: $60000 \div \text{BPM}$ gives one quarter note in milliseconds.
Nothing changes.	MIX is at 0% or the host Bypass parameter is on.

08 Parameter reference

Panel label	Host parameter	Range	Default
TIME	Time	60 to 1200 ms	240 ms
SIZE	Size	40 to 500 ms	160 ms
DENSITY	Density	2 to 24 gr/s	9.0 gr/s
SCATTER	Scatter	0 to 100%	32%
LEVEL VAR	Level Var	0 to 12 dB	0 dB
POSITION RAND	Position Rand	0 to 100%	32%
PITCH SPRAY	Pitch Spray	0 to 12 st	0.112 st
PITCH	Pitch	-12 to +24 st (whole semitones)	+12 st
REVERSE	Reverse	0 to 100%	18%
FEEDBACK	Feedback	0 to 88%	42%
TONE	Tone	1200 to 18000 Hz	9000 Hz
WIDTH	Width	0 to 200%	135%
MIX	Mix	0 to 100%	48%
—	Bypass	Off, On	Off

09 Version history

Version	Changes
1.0.0 · 2026-08-04	First release: octave-up granular voices with an early diffuser and an eight-line late tail; Level Var, Position Rand, and Pitch Spray; 100 factory presets; versioned preset and state migration.

10 Support and license

Report problems or request features at github.com/TaebeumKim/TB_Audio-Plugins/issues. Include the plug-in version, your DAW, and your operating system.

TB Audio plug-ins are free for personal and commercial work under the TB Audio Plug-ins Freeware License. If you release or monetize work made with them, add a credit such as **Made with TB Audio Plug-ins by Team Impulse Impact**. Selling or bundling the plug-ins is not allowed.

If the plug-ins help your music, you can support development at ko-fi.com/teamimpulseimpact.